

Stripe — Account Setup Hand-off

Purpose: set up an **LLC-owned** Stripe account, activate it for live payments, and invite the developer as a team member so they can wire up subscriptions. No secrets change hands by email for Stripe. **Money flow:** Stripe is where **money comes IN** — customers pay CradleHQ through Stripe, and Stripe pays out to the **LLC's bank account**. (This is the account that later also funds the print feature, where we collect the customer's payment here and pay the printer separately.) **Companion:** the payment *integration* is planned in `../payments/stripe-full-plan.md`. This doc covers **account creation + credentials**.

Before you start (have these ready)

- ☐ The **LLC's legal name + business address**.
- ☐ The LLC's **tax ID / EIN**.
- ☐ The **LLC's bank account details** (account + routing number) — this is where Stripe deposits the money customers pay.
- ☐ A **company representative's identity details** — Stripe legally requires a real person for the account: full name, date of birth, home address, and (US) the **last 4 of their SSN**.
- ☐ A **business email** for the account (an LLC address).

Steps

1. Go to **stripe.com** and sign up with the **business email**.
2. In **Business settings**, set the account type to **Company / LLC** and enter the LLC legal name, address, and **EIN**.
3. Enter the **representative's identity details** (Stripe's identity check / KYC).
4. **Link the LLC bank account** for payouts.
5. **Activate the account** — Stripe reviews the details; once approved, live payments are enabled.
6. 🌟 **Invite the developer as a team member**. Go to **Settings** → **Team**, invite the developer's email, and choose the **Developer** role. **This is the one technical step that matters** — it lets the developer create the subscription product, set up the webhook, and pull both the test- and live-mode keys themselves, so no secrets ever have to change hands by email.

That's the whole job. Everything below (product, price, webhook, keys) is done by the **developer** from inside the account once the invite is accepted — it's listed here only so you know what's happening.

What to hand back (the deliverable)

Nothing secret. Just confirm two things in a plain email:

1. The **developer's team invite was sent** (and, ideally, accepted).
2. The account is **activated** (or still under review — either is fine; the developer can work in test mode meanwhile).

What the developer sets up (for reference — not your task)

Once invited, the developer configures these from inside the account and reads the values directly:

```
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY=sk_live...      # live Secret key, from Developers → API keys
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET=whsec...    # from the production webhook endpoint they add
STRIPE_PRICE_PLUS_MONTHLY=price... # the "Plus" $4.99/mo recurring price they create
```

Notes / gotchas

- **The developer can start before activation** — Stripe's test mode works immediately, so build/testing isn't blocked while account review/bank verification completes (that can take a few days).
- **The team invite is the whole handoff** — because the developer has account access, there's no one-time-secret step for Stripe (unlike Anthropic and Lulu). If you ever remove the developer's access, they lose the ability to manage pricing and keys.
- **Never commit secrets** — the live secret key and webhook secret live only in the deployment's secrets, never in a document, email, or code.